

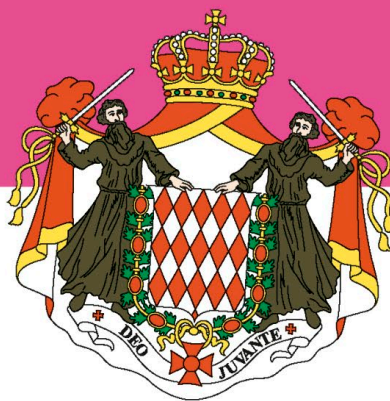
January

8

1297

Monk of Monaco

Francesco Grimaldi disguised himself as a monk to gain access to the Rock of Monaco. He then seized Monaco's fortress in an event commemorated on the country's coat of arms.



1912

African National Congress

The South African Native National Congress (SANNC), the forerunner of the African National Congress (ANC) was formed in South Africa. Its mission was to fight against the unjust and oppressive treatment of Black people.



Also on this day

1493 Italian explorer Christopher Columbus reported spotting mermaids off the coast of modern-day Dominican Republic. They turned out to be large, grey, ocean-dwelling mammals called manatees.

1877 Lakota warrior Crazy Horse fought his last battle against US soldiers at Wolf Mountain in Montana, USA. Crazy Horse was forced to surrender due to harsh weather.

2007

What's that smell?

A pungent smell of rotting eggs filled the streets of New York City, USA, on this day, alarming citizens. Fire trucks scrambled to detect the source without success, but fortunately the mystery odour faded that same day.

Born this day

1935 Elvis Presley, US singer. The biggest star of the rock 'n' roll era, the King – as he was known – made the new sound popular with his unique dance moves and soulful voice.

1947 David Bowie, British singer and songwriter. A master performer and a genius at reinventing himself, Bowie was a leading voice in glam rock.

